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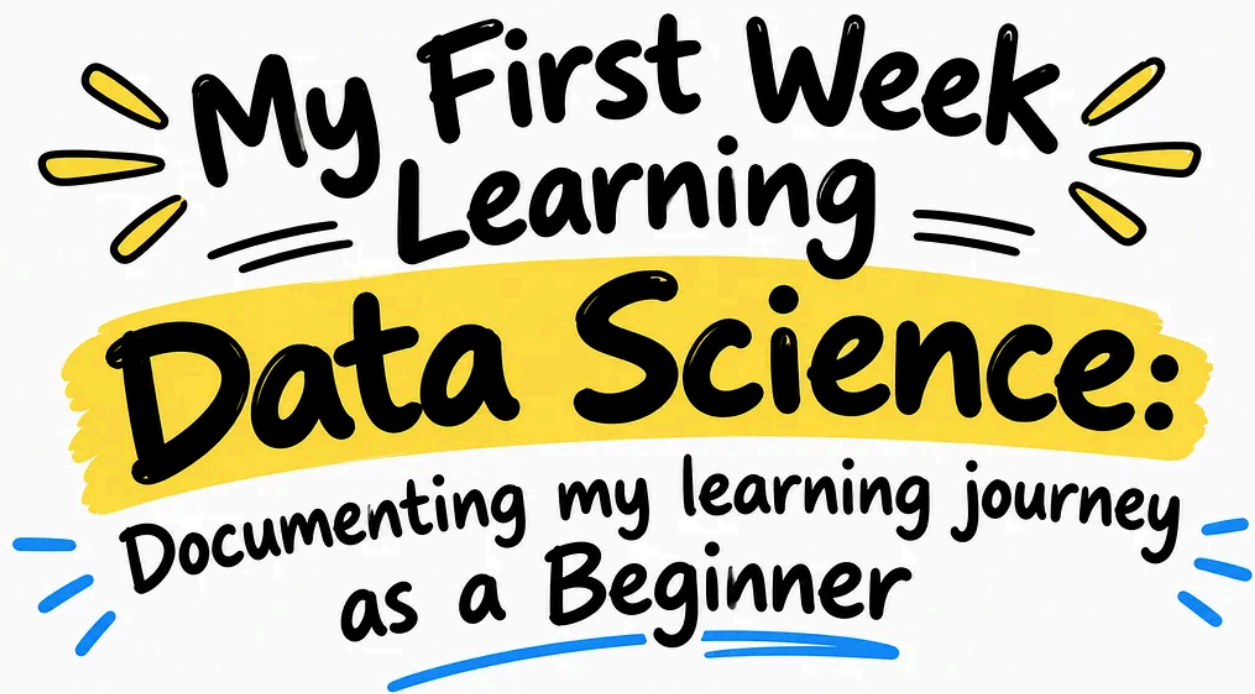
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4



My First Week Learning Data Science: I'm Not a Data Crusher, I'm a Problem Solver

Documenting my learning journey as a beginner in Data Science.

Starting something new can be exciting, confusing, frustrating, and inspiring all at the same time.

That has pretty much been my experience during my first week of learning Data Science.

I started this journey knowing that Data Science had something to do with data, Python, models, visualization, and a lot of coding. But after spending my first week actually learning, I'm beginning to realize that there is much more to it than I initially thought.

Data Science is not just about writing codes or creating beautiful visualizations.

It is about using data to solve problems and create impact.

And honestly, that changed the way I now look at this journey.

My First Week: Starting From the Basics

One of the first things I did was install Python and set up my learning environment.

It might sound like a small thing, but as a beginner, getting everything installed and ready felt like a win.

Before I start doing anything serious with data, I need to understand the basics first.

So, instead of jumping straight into Machine Learning or trying to build complicated models, I started with Python fundamentals.

And I quickly realized that even the "basics" have a lot to learn.

What I Learned in Python:

This week, I started learning some of the basic building blocks of Python.

Variables

I learned that variables are used to store information.

It looks simple, but I'm beginning to understand that these small things are the foundation for writing programs and working with data.

Data Types

I also learned about data types.

Some of the ones I came across are:

String—text

Integer—whole numbers

Float—numbers with decimals

Boolean—True or False values

At first, I wondered why I needed to know all these different types.

But I'm beginning to understand why they matter, especially because I'll eventually be working with real datasets where different columns can contain different types of information.

Input and Output

I also learned how Python can receive information from a user and display information back to the user.

This was interesting because it helped me understand how programs can interact with people instead of just running instructions in the background.

Basic Operations

I practiced basic mathematical operations such as addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division.

Nothing too complicated yet, but I'm learning that I shouldn't overlook these basic concepts.

I need to get comfortable with them before moving to more advanced things.

If, Elif and Else

Another thing I learned was conditional statements.

I learned how "if", "elif", and "else" can be used to make decisions in a program.

This was one of those moments where I started seeing that programming is not just about telling the computer what to do.

I can also give it conditions and allow it to respond differently depending on the situation.

I'm still getting the hang of it, but I'm learning.

And Then There Were Errors

Let me not pretend everything went smoothly.

It didn't.

There were errors.

A missing bracket here.

A spelling mistake there.

Indentation issues.

And those moments where I looked at my work wondering, "What exactly did I do wrong?"

Debugging has already become part of my learning experience.

At first, seeing an error can be frustrating, especially when you feel like you've done everything correctly.

But I'm slowly learning not to panic when I see one.

An error doesn't necessarily mean I can't do it.

Sometimes it simply means:

"Look again."

And that's exactly what I'm learning to do.

But I Learned Something Bigger Than Python

While learning these Python basics, I also started understanding something about Data Science that really stood out to me.

Data Science isn't only about writing codes and making awesome visualizations.

Those things are important, but they are tools.

The bigger picture is what we can actually do with the data.

Data can help an organization understand what is happening, make better decisions, identify opportunities, understand customers, improve products, and solve problems.

The impact can come in different forms.

It can be:

- a. Insights that help an organization make better decisions.
- b. Data products that make information more useful.
- c. Product recommendations that improve the customer experience.
- d. Predictions that help with planning.
- e. Solutions to real-world problems.

That really made me think about what kind of Data Scientist I want to become.

What Really Stood Out for Me

One thing that really stood out to me is that being a Data Scientist isn't just about how good the model is.

You can build a very impressive model, but if it doesn't solve a problem or create any meaningful impact, then what is the point?



That made me start thinking beyond the technical side.

Instead of only asking:

"Can I build this model?"

I also want to learn to ask:

"What problem am I solving?"

"Who does this solution help?"

"What impact can this create?"

"What decision can this data help someone make?"

I think developing this mindset early will be important for me.

I'm Not a Data Crusher. I'm a Problem Solver.

This has probably been my biggest takeaway from Week One.

As I continue learning and broadening my knowledge in Data Science, I want to remind myself that:

I'm not a data crusher. I'm a problem solver.

I don't want to just process datasets, write complicated codes, or build models simply because I know how to.

I want to be able to look at a real-world problem and think:

"How can data help solve this?"

That's the mindset I want to carry with me throughout this journey.

The Tools I'm Exploring

There is still so much ahead of me.

Some of the tools and areas I'm beginning to explore include:

- Python
- Data Visualization
- Pandas
- NumPy

- Jupyter Notebook
- Artificial Intelligence
- Machine Learning

Looking at this list can honestly feel like a lot.

But I'm reminding myself that I don't need to know everything at once.

I'll learn them one step at a time.

The Challenges So Far

The journey hasn't been without its challenges.

New Concepts

There are many concepts I'm seeing for the first time. Sometimes I understand something immediately, and sometimes I have to go back and look at it again.

And that's okay.

Complex Terms

Data Science has a lot of terms that are completely new to me.

Sometimes I learn one thing and realize there are three other things I need to understand first.

Debugging Errors

Writing code and getting an error can be frustrating.

But I'm learning that debugging is part of the process, not something I should be afraid of.

Patience

This one is probably the hardest.

I want to understand everything quickly, but I'm learning that I can't.

And honestly, I don't have to.

My Goals

As I continue learning, I have a few things I want to achieve:

1. Build a strong foundation

I want to properly understand the basics instead of rushing through them.

2. Work on real projects

I want to move beyond just following tutorials and eventually work on projects that solve real problems.

3. Improve my skills

I want every lesson, mistake, and challenge to make me better.

4. Become a Data Scientist

That's the big goal.

I know it won't happen overnight. There is still a lot for me to learn, but I'm willing to take the journey one step at a time.

One Week Down, Many More to Go!!!

When I look at everything I did this week, it may not seem like a lot compared to how much there is still to learn.

But I'm learning to appreciate small progress.

This week, I:

- Installed Python.

Set up my learning environment

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Practiced basic Python operations.

- Learned about if, elif, and else.
- Started dealing with debugging errors.
- Began exploring some of the tools used in Data Science.
- And most importantly, started thinking differently about what it means to be a Data Scientist.

I know the next few weeks won't always be easy.

There will be concepts I won't understand immediately.

There will be errors that will frustrate me.

There will probably be days when I feel like I'm not learning fast enough.

But I'm reminding myself that I'm not in a race.

I'm learning.

I'm growing.

I'm figuring things out.

And I'm still becoming.

Progress, not perfection.

This is only Week One, and I'm excited to see where this journey takes me.

#ProgressNotPerfection #ImStillBecoming #DataScience #DataScientist
#LearningJourney #Python #DataRaFlow



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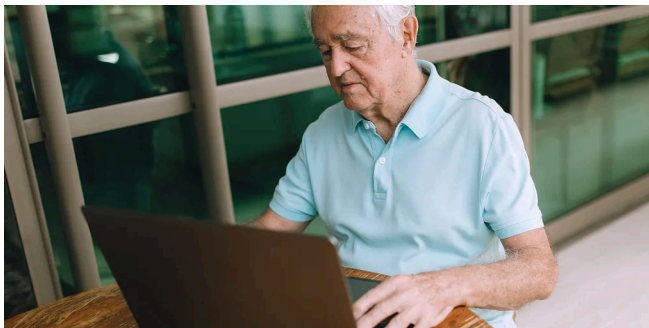
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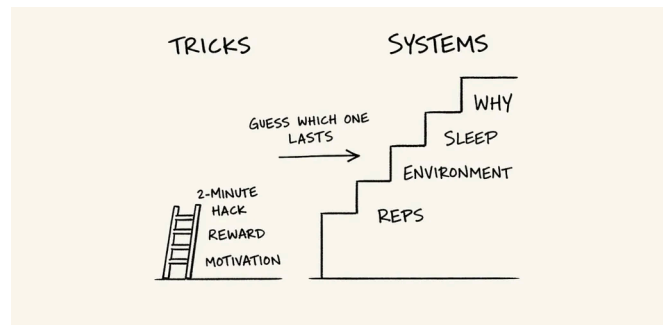
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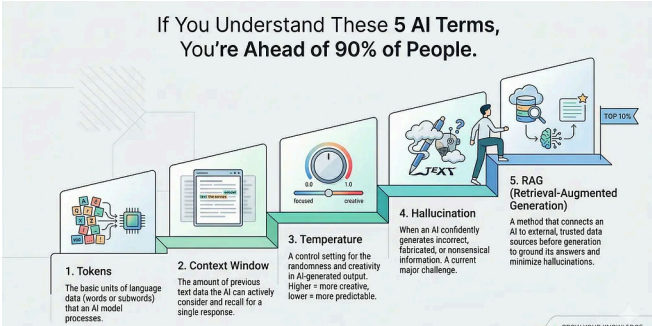
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